Diversified Bottleneck Stock Research Report — V2

10 research candidates across 10 different themes

Prepared: 4 Oct 2026 (America/New_York) | Evidence cutoff: 4 Oct 2026 | Jev model: jev-1.13.0 | Prepared for Eric Su (scheduled biweekly scan)

Important: This report is for research and education only. It is not financial advice, not a recommendation to buy or sell securities, and does not consider personal risk tolerance, time horizon, tax situation, or portfolio. Small-cap and thematic stocks can be extremely volatile.

Research-queue note: researchPriorityTier (deprioritize | watch | prioritize | top_research | immediate_deep_dive), bottleneckResearchScore and the Jev route (pass | watch | reject) order research attention only. They are not buy, sell, strong-buy, timing or position-size signals, and this report contains no price targets or entry prices.

Executive summary

Premise: start from a measurable demand wave (AI-driven chip capacity, power generation, naval shipbuilding, nuclear fuel, electrification metals, magnets, defense autonomy, data-center infrastructure, aero engines, medical sterilization), find the layer with the lowest qualified-output ceiling, and ask whether the selected company controls that layer and captures value. **Classification mix: 0 Potentially Hard to Scale, 10 Probably Temporary.** No name cleared all five mandatory gates this cycle. ASML (supply lag 0.67) and BWXT (value capture 0.47) each failed exactly one gate; GE Vernova failed two (workaround 0.66, value capture 0.72). All three were Potentially Hard to Scale on 21 Sep; the change reflects fresh evidence packets that give more weight to funded capacity steps, competing OEM expansion and monopsony pricing, plus run-to-run variation in Jev near the 0.75 threshold. Treat near-threshold results as low-margin calls.

Jev routing: 7 *pass* (active research list: ASML, BWXT, SHC, GEV, HWM, MP, CCJ); 3 *watch* (secondary list: AVAV, VRT, FCX); none *reject*, so no substitution was required. The watch names were re-run once with added evidence as the protocol requires; routes did not change. Themes that failed the evidence bar: none of the ten researched themes failed sourcing. Cybersecurity and energy storage (default themes) were not carried forward because their prior candidates (CRWD, FLNC) were Jev *reject* on 21 Sep and no stronger bottleneck candidate was identified this cycle; AI optics (COHR), advanced packaging (AMKR) and onsite fuel-cell power (BE) were removed for hidden concentration, not for weak evidence. **Principal uncertainty:** how quickly funded capacity (EUV +30% steps, three-OEM turbine expansion, casting acquisitions, X-ray sterilization) closes gaps relative to demand that is itself concentrated in AI and government budgets.

One-theme-per-stock watchlist

Ranked by bottleneckResearchScore (computed in code from Jev Score features). Rank is a research-queue order only.

Rank	Ticker	Theme	Durability indicator	Confidence	Scanner thesis	Risk
1	**ASML**	EUV lithography systems for leading-edge logic and DRAM	**Probably Temporary**	Medium	ASML is the only commercial EUV supplier and 2027 Low-NA capacity is close to fully booked, but planned ~30% annual capacity steps meant Jev did not judge qualified supply to stay behind demand through the horizon.	Medium
2	**BWXT**	U.S. naval nuclear propulsion reactor components	**Probably Temporary**	Medium	BWXT is the established supplier of U.S. naval reactor components under multi-year task orders, but Jev judged value capture weak because a single government buyer limits scarcity pricing.	Medium
3	**SHC**	Cobalt-60 supply and contract sterilization capacity for medical devices	**Probably Temporary**	Medium	Sotera's Nordion supplies Cobalt-60, a decaying isotope made in few reactors on multi-year cycles, and Sterigenics runs regulated sterilization capacity; Jev saw strong time gates and entry barriers but judged X-ray substitution and capture uncertain.	High
4	**GEV**	Heavy-duty gas turbine manufacturing slots for new power generation	**Probably Temporary**	Medium	Gas turbine commitments (116 GW under contract) far exceed GE Vernova's 20–24 GW per year output, but all three OEMs are expanding and behind-the-meter alternatives are growing, so Jev failed the workaround and value-capture gates.	Medium
5	**HWM**	Superalloy turbine airfoil investment castings for jet engines	**Probably Temporary**	Medium	Howmet supplies superalloy turbine airfoil castings with expanding margins, but engine shortages are easing and GE Aerospace is integrating castings via CPP, so Jev judged supply lag, workarounds and capture insufficient.	Medium
6	**MP**	Non-China rare earth separation and NdFeB magnet supply	**Probably Temporary**	Medium	MP is the scaled Western NdPr producer moving into magnets, but ex-China NdPr is oversupplied and below the DoD $110/kg floor, so capture depends on policy support; Jev failed value capture decisively.	Very High

Rank	Ticker	Theme	Durability indicator	Confidence	Scanner thesis	Risk
7	**CCJ**	Western uranium mining and conversion supply under long-term contracts	**Probably Temporary**	Medium	Term uranium prices are at decade highs and primary supply is constrained, but uranium is a globally priced commodity where secondary supply and restarts can respond, so Jev failed supply lag, workaround and capture.	Medium-High
8	**AVAV**	Loitering munitions and tactical autonomous strike systems	**Probably Temporary**	Medium	Army demand for loitering munitions is real (record $1.5B funded backlog), but DoD is deliberately buying cheap one-way attack drones from many vendors, so Jev failed all five gates and routed AVAV to watch.	High
9	**VRT**	AI data-center power and liquid-cooling infrastructure	**Probably Temporary**	Medium	AI rack densification drives Vertiv's power and liquid-cooling growth with expanding margins, but around 40 CDU vendors, active M&A and largely standard manufacturing let supply respond quickly, so Jev routed VRT to watch.	Medium-High
10	**FCX**	Copper mine supply for electrification	**Probably Temporary**	High	Copper mine supply is structurally slow and concentrate is scarce, but Freeport is a price-taking producer and ICSG forecasts refined surpluses for 2026–27, so Jev failed four gates including value capture.	High

Durability cells always print the exact label; amber shading = Probably Temporary, teal = Potentially Hard to Scale. Color is never the only signal.

Jev research-queue metrics (research priority only — not investment advice)

Rank	Ticker	bottleneckResearchScore	researchPriorityTier	Route	Failed Noul gates (threshold 0.75)
1	ASML	79	top_research	pass	supply lag 0.67
2	BWXT	76	top_research	pass	value capture 0.47
3	SHC	71	top_research	pass	supply lag 0.65, workaround lag 0.59, value capture 0.72
4	GEV	70	top_research	pass	workaround lag 0.66, value capture 0.72
5	HWM	67	top_research	pass	supply lag 0.54, workaround lag 0.66, value capture 0.70
6	MP	60	prioritize	pass	supply lag 0.70, workaround lag 0.68, value capture 0.28
7	CCJ	60	prioritize	pass	supply lag 0.64, workaround lag 0.67, value capture 0.44
8	AVAV	56	prioritize	watch	time gate 0.48, supply lag 0.64, workaround lag 0.44, entry barrier 0.32, value capture 0.39
9	VRT	53	prioritize	watch	time gate 0.69, supply lag 0.54, workaround lag 0.46, entry barrier 0.41, value capture 0.66
10	FCX	44	watch	watch	supply lag 0.37, workaround lag 0.28, entry barrier 0.31, value capture 0.16

MP and CCJ both round to 60; MP ranks higher on the unrounded score (60.19 vs 60.13).

V2 methodology

Demand versus qualified supply. Required bottleneck input = end demand × input intensity; qualified supply = nameplate × yield × uptime × customer-qualified share. Announced nameplate capacity is never treated as qualified output. **Three clocks.** A bottleneck is potentially durable only if the demand clock stays faster than both the qualified-supply clock (funding, build, yield, certification) and the workaround clock (redesign, substitution, recycling, second sourcing) over the stated horizon. **Seven tests** inform each judgment: multi-constraint, money-and-time, substitution-and-intensity, entry barrier, full cycle, bottleneck migration and value capture. **Industry scarcity is not company capture:** a hard industry problem with weak company capture is Probably Temporary at the stock level.

Conservative rule (code, not Jev). Each stock's evidence packet (dated source excerpts, URLs and source types) was sent to TypeSafe Jev (jev-1.13.0) for five Noul gates, six Score dimensions and a Choice route. Potentially Hard to Scale requires all five gate probabilities ≥ 0.75 (non-capital time gate, qualified supply lag, workaround lag, observed entry barrier, company value capture); anything else is Probably Temporary, and missing or mixed evidence counts as a failed gate. Code computes bottleneckResearchScore = 100 × (0.20·evidence/4 + 0.20·value capture/4 + 0.20·intensity/4 + 0.15·demand durability/4 + 0.15·exclusivity/4 + 0.10·research priority/4), +5 if Potentially Hard to Scale (cap 100), and ranks by it. Score never overrides a failed gate. Confidence and risk labels are analyst judgments under the framework.

Hidden-concentration check. Only one stock per primary spending pool: VRT is the single AI data-center capex name (COHR, AMKR and BE were dropped as the same pool). Disclosed partial overlaps: ~20% of GE Vernova's contracted gigawatts are for data centers; Howmet's gas-turbine sales (13% of revenue) ride the same power wave as GEV, but its primary driver is commercial aerospace (53%); ASML's demand is AI-influenced but set by foundry and DRAM capex, a different buyer and constraint. BWXT (Navy propulsion) and CCJ (uranium price) and AVAV (Army munitions) draw on different budgets or prices.

Framework references (foundations, not stock evidence): Epoch AI, multiple constraints (https://epoch.ai/publications/can-ai-scaling-continue-through-2030); Howard Marks, high rewards attract supply (https://www.oaktreecapital.com/insights/memo/more-on-repealing-the-laws-of-economics); Mauboussin and Callahan, entry, scale and switching costs (https://www.morganstanley.com/im/publication/insights/articles/article_measuringthemoat.pdf).

Per-stock deep dives

Bracketed numbers such as [2] cite the numbered entries in that stock's Sources list. 'Inference' marks analyst reasoning; 'management claim' marks unverified company statements.

ASML — ASML Holding N.V. (ADR)

Theme: EUV lithography systems for leading-edge logic and DRAM

Durability indicator: **Probably Temporary**

Confidence: Medium

Research horizon: 3–5 years **Risk:** Medium

Thesis

ASML is the only commercial EUV supplier and 2027 Low-NA capacity is close to fully booked, but planned ~30% annual capacity steps meant Jev did not judge qualified supply to stay behind demand through the horizon.

Three-clock assessment

Demand: AI-driven Logic and DRAM capacity additions: ~65 Low-NA EUV shipments expected in 2026 with EUV system sales up more than 45%; FY2026 sales guided to EUR 43–45B [1][2].

Qualified-supply: ASML plans ~30% more Low-NA capacity for 2027 and is investigating another ~30% for 2028; 2027 is close to fully covered by orders and a significant number of 2028 orders are in hand [1][2]. These are management statements; no independent unit count was found.

Workaround: No alternate EUV supplier exists. UBS puts China's EUV effort near ASML's 2004 level and sees no practical alternative within ~10 years [3]. Low-NA multipatterning versus High-NA is a substitution inside ASML's own portfolio.

Why the indicator may be right

- The sole supplier is itself funding a large response: about 30% more Low-NA capacity for 2027 and a possible further ~30% for 2028 [1].
- Demand is concentrated in one AI-driven Logic/DRAM capex wave; inference: a capex pause could loosen a booked-out schedule quickly.
- China is ~20% of 2026 sales and faces pressure for stricter export controls, a demand-side vulnerability [4].
- Jev qualified-supply-lag probability was 0.67, below the 0.75 gate.

Evidence against the indicator

- ASML remains the only producer of advanced EUV tools and UBS sees no practical Chinese alternative within a decade [3].
- 2027 Low-NA demand is close to fully ordered before the capacity step lands, and significant 2028 orders already exist [2].
- 54.0% Q2 gross margin with 55–57% guided for Q3 points to pricing power [1].
- Jev passed the other four gates, including entry barrier (0.91) and value capture (0.88).

Company value capture

Strong. Q2 gross margin 54.0% and Q3 guide 55–57%; Installed Base Management sales expected to grow more than 30% in 2026 on the expanding EUV fleet [1][2]. Limits: a handful of leading-edge customers, and pricing changes flow through multi-year order books (inference).

What would flip the indicator

Evidence that 2028 demand exceeds even the additional ~30% step (for example, 2028 effectively sold out before the expansion is approved) without customer fab push-outs would likely lift the supply-lag gate. Order push-outs or cancellations for 2027 would deepen the Temporary reading.

What to monitor

- 2028 Low-NA order coverage versus the capacity decision
- Q3 2026 bookings and backlog commentary
- China revenue share and new export-control rules

Key risks (overall risk: Medium)

- Export controls and U.S.–China geopolitics
- AI semiconductor capex cyclicality
- Customer concentration among leading-edge fabs
- High-NA adoption timing

Jev second opinion

Model **jev-1.13.0** | durability (code): **Probably Temporary** | route: **pass** | bottleneckResearchScore: **79** | researchPriorityTier: **top_research** (research-queue label only, not investment advice). Hard-to-Scale blocked by failed gate(s): supply lag.

Noul gate	P(true)	Result
1. Non-capital time gate	0.81	PASS
2. Qualified supply lag	0.67	FAIL
3. Workaround lag	0.84	PASS
4. Observed entry barrier	0.91	PASS
5. Company value capture	0.88	PASS

Score (0–4)	Value
evidence_strength	2.57
value_capture_strength	3.24
bottleneck_intensity	3.44
demand_durability	2.59
constraint_exclusivity	4.00
research_priority	3.33

Sources

[1] **ASML Q2 2026 financial results press release** — 2026-07-15 (primary): https://www.asml.com/en/news/press-releases/2026/q2-2026-financial-results

[2] **ASML Q2 2026 investor call transcript** — 2026-07-15 (primary): https://ourbrand.asml.com/asset/1fd3908a-0381-47b5-9b69-a3094f656651/2026_07_15-ASML-Transcript-investor-call-Q2-2026.pdf

[3] **Asia Business Daily — UBS: China's EUV technology at ASML's 2004 level** — 2026-09-03 (independent): https://www.asiae.co.kr/en/article/2026090309382047396

[4] **CNBC — ASML on tightrope between sales and geopolitics** — 2026-07-17 (newswire): https://www.cnbc.com/2026/07/17/us-china-ai-feud-asml-tightrope-sales-geopolitics.html

BWXT — BWX Technologies, Inc.

Theme: U.S. naval nuclear propulsion reactor components

Durability indicator: **Probably Temporary**

Confidence: Medium

Research horizon: 5+ years **Risk:** Medium

Thesis

BWXT is the established supplier of U.S. naval reactor components under multi-year task orders, but Jev judged value capture weak because a single government buyer limits scarcity pricing.

Three-clock assessment

Demand: Navy goal of one Columbia and two Virginia submarines per year; GAO says DOD still lacks a complete estimate of the funding and time to get there [4]. BWXT's $1.285B long-lead materials award is the first of five annual task orders through 2030 [3].

Qualified-supply: BWXT has delivered more than 420 reactor cores [3]; backlog $8.4B (+40% YoY) with Government Operations at $6.80B versus $4.44B a year earlier [2][5]. Shipyard and supplier delays slow conversion [4].

Workaround: No practical substitute exists for naval nuclear propulsion; inference: schedule slips defer rather than remove component demand.

Why the indicator may be right

- The customer is effectively a single government buyer; inference: that limits conversion of scarcity into price. Jev value-capture probability was 0.47.
- Revenue timing depends on shipyard throughput, which GAO documents as delayed [4].
- Backlog dipped modestly quarter on quarter because large multi-year awards are lumpy [5].
- The announced sale of the medical business removes the isotope adjacency that earlier reports leaned on [1].

Evidence against the indicator

- Jev passed four gates strongly: time gate 0.90, supply lag 0.81, workaround lag 0.86, entry barrier 0.90.
- No observed new entrant into naval reactor components; GAO describes an atrophied submarine supplier base [4].
- Multi-year task-order structure through 2030 [3] and trailing 12-month book-to-bill of 1.7x [5].

Company value capture

Mixed. Raised 2026 guidance (adjusted EBITDA $662–672M, non-GAAP EPS $4.70–4.80, free cash flow $345–360M) shows the franchise earns well [1], but government contracting likely caps scarcity rents (inference). Mixed capture was not supported strongly enough to pass the gate.

What would flip the indicator

Evidence that naval contract economics improve with scarcity (for example, rising Government Operations margins on new awards, or customer-funded capacity with favorable terms) would be needed to lift the value-capture gate.

What to monitor

- FY2027 Navy shipbuilding funding and the 30-year plan
- Government Operations margin and backlog conversion
- GAO/Navy updates on Columbia and Virginia schedules

Key risks (overall risk: Medium)

- Single-customer and federal budget risk
- Shipyard schedule slips
- Nuclear component quality and execution
- Competition in commercial nuclear lines

Jev second opinion

Model **jev-1.13.0** | durability (code): **Probably Temporary** | route: **pass** | bottleneckResearchScore: **76** | researchPriorityTier: **top_research** (research-queue label only, not investment advice). Hard-to-Scale blocked by failed gate(s): value capture.

Noul gate	P(true)	Result
1. Non-capital time gate	0.90	PASS
2. Qualified supply lag	0.81	PASS
3. Workaround lag	0.86	PASS
4. Observed entry barrier	0.90	PASS
5. Company value capture	0.47	FAIL

Score (0–4)	Value
evidence_strength	2.58
value_capture_strength	2.39
bottleneck_intensity	3.90
demand_durability	2.69
constraint_exclusivity	3.84
research_priority	2.90

Sources

[1] **BWXT Q2 2026 results press release** — 2026-08-03 (primary): https://investors.bwxt.com/news-releases/news-release-details/bwx-technologies-reports-second-quarter-2026-results

[2] **BWXT Q2 2026 results exhibit 99.1 (SEC)** — 2026-08-03 (primary): https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1486957/000148695726000041/bwxt_63026xerexhibit991.htm

[3] **BWXT — $1.4B contracts for Naval Nuclear Propulsion Program** — 2026-05-07 (primary): https://investors.bwxt.com/news-releases/news-release-details/bwxt-announces-14-billion-contracts-naval-nuclear-propulsion

[4] **GAO-26-109068 Navy and Coast Guard Shipbuilding** — 2026-04-22 (independent): https://files.gao.gov/reports/GAO-26-109068/index.html

[5] **BWXT Q2 2026 earnings call transcript** — 2026-08-03 (primary): https://stockanalysis.com/stocks/bwxt/transcripts/660315-q2-2026/

SHC — Sotera Health Company

Theme: Cobalt-60 supply and contract sterilization capacity for medical devices

Durability indicator: **Probably Temporary**

Confidence: Medium

Research horizon: 5+ years **Risk:** High

Thesis

Sotera's Nordion supplies Cobalt-60, a decaying isotope made in few reactors on multi-year cycles, and Sterigenics runs regulated sterilization capacity; Jev saw strong time gates and entry barriers but judged X-ray substitution and capture uncertain.

Three-clock assessment

Demand: Steady medical-device and pharma sterilization demand; NextBeam estimates ~40% of companies rely on gamma [2]. Q2 revenue +9.2% and FY2026 outlook raised [1].

Qualified-supply: Co-60 cannot be stockpiled (half-life ~5.27 years); new PWR-based supply needs ~4.5 years to reach commercial activity levels [2].

Workaround: NextBeam (an e-beam/X-ray provider, so an interested party) reports expanding X-ray capacity offering gamma-equivalent penetration and expects most market growth to go to accelerator modalities [2]. Switching requires product revalidation.

Why the indicator may be right

- X-ray and e-beam capacity is expanding and can absorb much of future growth for radiation-compatible products [2].
- Nordion revenue moves with Co-60 harvest timing, which drove much of Q2 volume growth [1].
- EO rules remain in flux under an EPA reconsideration proposal [3]; Sotera's outlook assumes EO and Co-60 supply continuity [1].
- Jev failed supply lag (0.65), workaround lag (0.59) and value capture (0.72, just under the gate).

Evidence against the indicator

- Non-capital time gate scored 0.93: decay physics and multi-year reactor cycles cannot be bought down [2].
- Co-60 contracts have historically repriced upward after supply disruptions [2].
- Nordion segment income of $28M on $49M revenue with favorable pricing [1]; entry-barrier gate 0.88.

Company value capture

Mixed to Strong. Adjusted EBITDA margin 51.6%, Sterigenics and Nordion both citing favorable pricing [1]. Offsets: $2.2B total debt (net leverage 3.0x) and ~$13M per quarter of EO-related professional fees [1].

What would flip the indicator

Multi-year Co-60 contracts at rising prices while X-ray additions fail to slow gamma demand would support the supply-lag and capture gates. Large X-ray build-outs taking validated volume would deepen the Temporary reading.

What to monitor

- Nordion harvest schedule and Co-60 pricing
- EPA final action on the EtO sterilizer rule
- EO litigation developments and settlements

Key risks (overall risk: High)

- EO litigation and possible new claims
- Leverage ($2.2B debt)
- EPA/nuclear regulation
- Co-60 supply disruption, including Russia-related sanctions risk noted in filings

Jev second opinion

Model **jev-1.13.0** | durability (code): **Probably Temporary** | route: **pass** | bottleneckResearchScore: **71** | researchPriorityTier: **top_research** (research-queue label only, not investment advice). Hard-to-Scale blocked by failed gate(s): supply lag, workaround lag, value capture.

Noul gate	P(true)	Result
1. Non-capital time gate	0.93	PASS
2. Qualified supply lag	0.65	FAIL
3. Workaround lag	0.59	FAIL
4. Observed entry barrier	0.88	PASS
5. Company value capture	0.72	FAIL

Score (0–4)	Value
evidence_strength	2.49
value_capture_strength	2.79
bottleneck_intensity	3.47
demand_durability	2.50
constraint_exclusivity	2.61
research_priority	3.11

Sources

[1] **Sotera Health Q2 2026 results (SEC Ex-99.1)** — 2026-08-06 (primary):
https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1822479/000182247926000044/august62026-ex991.htm

[2] **NextBeam — The 2026 Gamma and Cobalt Outlook** — 2026-03-13 (independent):
https://nextbeam.com/irradiation-illuminated/the-2026-gamma-and-cobalt-outlook/

[3] **Federal Register — EPA proposed EtO sterilization NESHAP reconsideration** — 2026-03-17 (independent):
https://www.govinfo.gov/content/pkg/FR-2026-03-17/html/2026-05167.htm

GEV — GE Vernova Inc.

Theme: Heavy-duty gas turbine manufacturing slots for new power generation

Durability indicator: **Probably Temporary**

Confidence: Medium

Research horizon: 3–5 years **Risk:** Medium

Thesis

Gas turbine commitments (116 GW under contract) far exceed GE Vernova's 20–24 GW per year output, but all three OEMs are expanding and behind-the-meter alternatives are growing, so Jev failed the workaround and value-capture gates.

Three-clock assessment

Demand: 116 GW of gas backlog plus slot reservations, at least 125 GW expected by year-end; ~100 customers in 26 countries, ~20% data centers [1][2].

Qualified-supply: Output of 20 GW per year from Q3 2026, 24 GW in 2028, actions toward 30 GW in 2030 [1]. Siemens Energy lead times run three years or more [3]; Mitsubishi's new orders deliver 2028–2030 [4].

Workaround: Jefferies calls behind-the-meter generation a near-term winner and projects available OEM capacity of 49 GW in 2029 and 76 GW in 2030; Wood Mackenzie expects lead times to start falling by 2027 [5].

Why the indicator may be right

- All three OEMs are adding capacity: Siemens Energy +15 large units in 2027, Mitsubishi doubling versus 2024 [3][4].
- Jefferies says turbine OEMs are increasingly not the primary bottleneck for large loads [5] (outside estimate, Feb 2026).
- Slot reservation agreements are not firm orders until converted [1].
- Company-wide net income margin was only 5.8% in Q2 [1]; Jev value capture 0.72 and workaround lag 0.66.

Evidence against the indicator

- Contracted gigawatts are roughly five times annual output (116 GW versus 20–24 GW) [1].
- Peers are sold out into 2028–2030 and report improving profitability on new orders [3][4].
- Power orders rose on higher volume and price; Power EBITDA margin +240 bp to 18.8% [1].
- Wood Mackenzie expects little impact on capacity additions until 2030 and beyond [5].

Company value capture

Mixed. Pricing and large slot-reservation down payments (Q2 free cash flow $5.1B) show real capture [1], but company margins are diluted by other segments and OEM bidding is competitive.

What would flip the indicator

Sustained price increases on new slots plus high reservation-to-order conversion with few cancellations through 2027 would support the workaround and capture gates. Falling lead times in 2027, as Jefferies and Wood Mackenzie project, would deepen the Temporary reading.

What to monitor

- Reservation-to-order conversion and cancellations
- Peer lead-time and capacity announcements
- Behind-the-meter engine and aeroderivative orders

Key risks (overall risk: Medium)

- Data-center load forecasts disappointing
- OEM capacity race compressing pricing
- Execution on the output ramp
- Policy and permitting shifts

Jev second opinion

Model **jev-1.13.0** | durability (code): **Probably Temporary** | route: **pass** | bottleneckResearchScore: **70** | researchPriorityTier: **top_research** (research-queue label only, not investment advice). Hard-to-Scale blocked by failed gate(s): workaround lag, value capture.

Noul gate	P(true)	Result
1. Non-capital time gate	0.79	PASS
2. Qualified supply lag	0.77	PASS
3. Workaround lag	0.66	FAIL
4. Observed entry barrier	0.79	PASS
5. Company value capture	0.72	FAIL

Score (0–4)	Value
evidence_strength	2.31
value_capture_strength	3.09
bottleneck_intensity	3.31
demand_durability	3.01
constraint_exclusivity	2.08
research_priority	2.78

Sources

[1] **GE Vernova 2Q 2026 results press release (SEC exhibit)** — 2026-07-22 (primary):
https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1996810/000199681026000147/gevpressrelease2q26.htm

[2] **GE Vernova 2Q 2026 earnings call transcript** — 2026-07-22 (primary):
https://www.gevernova.com/sites/default/files/gev_webcast_transcript_07222026.pdf

[3] **Utility Dive — Siemens Energy gas turbine backlog nears 70 GW** — 2026-08-10 (independent):
https://www.utilitydive.com/news/siemens-gas-turbine-backlog-nears-70-gw-as-company-expands-manufacturing/827390/

[4] **Utility Dive — Mitsubishi large-frame gas turbine backlog reaches 35 GW** — 2026-08-13 (independent):
https://www.utilitydive.com/news/mitsubishi-gas-turbine-backlog-earnings/827761/

[5] **Manufacturing Dive — Natural gas equipment bottleneck is easing, analysts say** — 2026-02-24 (independent):
https://www.manufacturingdive.com/news/natural-gas-equipment-generation-bottleneck-data-centers/813087/

HWM — Howmet Aerospace Inc.

Theme: Superalloy turbine airfoil investment castings for jet engines

Durability indicator: **Probably Temporary**

Confidence: Medium

Research horizon: 3–5 years **Risk:** Medium

Thesis

Howmet supplies superalloy turbine airfoil castings with expanding margins, but engine shortages are easing and GE Aerospace is integrating castings via CPP, so Jev judged supply lag, workarounds and capture insufficient.

Three-clock assessment

Demand: Commercial aerospace is 53% of revenue (+28% YoY) and gas turbines 13% (+38%) [1][4]; CFM LEAP deliveries rose 41% in H1 2026 [3].

Qualified-supply: 2026 IGT growth came mainly from yield improvements on existing assets; new capacity in Japan, Europe and Virginia [5]. GE says casting capacity investment is needed [2].

Workaround: GE Aerospace is buying CPP for $11.75B (closing expected 2H 2027) [2]; Safran says LEAP shortages are over for 2026–27 [3].

Why the indicator may be right

- Safran: 'the times of engine shortages are over' [3].
- Engine OEM vertical integration (GE–CPP) adds captive casting supply and bargaining power [2].
- Howmet's own yield gains on existing assets are a supply response [5].
- Jev failed supply lag (0.54), workaround lag (0.66) and value capture (0.70).

Evidence against the indicator

- Engine Products margin 37.7%, up 470 bp YoY [1].
- Howmet cites more than 50% global share of IGT turbine blades [5].
- GE chose to pay $11.75B rather than build casting capacity (inference: entry is slow) [2]; entry-barrier gate 0.85.

Company value capture

Strong to Mixed. Margin expansion and Q2 free cash flow of $479M [1]; but a few engine OEMs dominate purchasing and one is integrating backward.

What would flip the indicator

Multi-year pricing agreements and capacity sold out beyond 2028 despite CPP would support the gates. Margin compression or OEM insourcing would deepen the Temporary reading.

What to monitor

- Engine Products margin trend
- GE–CPP closing and integration
- LEAP/GTF delivery rates and spares demand

Key risks (overall risk: Medium)

- OEM concentration and vertical integration
- Aerospace cycle
- Gas-turbine demand partly shared with GEV's power wave
- Rising capex needs

Jev second opinion

Model **jev-1.13.0** | durability (code): **Probably Temporary** | route: **pass** | bottleneckResearchScore: **67** | researchPriorityTier: **top_research** (research-queue label only, not investment advice). Hard-to-Scale blocked by failed gate(s): supply lag, workaround lag, value capture.

Noul gate	P(true)	Result
1. Non-capital time gate	0.84	PASS
2. Qualified supply lag	0.54	FAIL
3. Workaround lag	0.66	FAIL
4. Observed entry barrier	0.85	PASS
5. Company value capture	0.70	FAIL

Score (0–4)	Value
evidence_strength	2.18
value_capture_strength	2.77
bottleneck_intensity	3.26
demand_durability	2.09
constraint_exclusivity	2.75
research_priority	3.05

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MP — MP Materials Corp.

Theme: Non-China rare earth separation and NdFeB magnet supply

Durability indicator: **Probably Temporary**

Confidence: Medium

Research horizon: 5+ years **Risk:** Very High

Thesis

MP is the scaled Western NdPr producer moving into magnets, but ex-China NdPr is oversupplied and below the DoD $110/kg floor, so capture depends on policy support; Jev failed value capture decisively.

Three-clock assessment

Demand: NdPr sales 1,006 t (+127%) in Q2; new gadolinium offtake with a U.S. aerospace and defense customer [1].

Qualified-supply: ~1,000 t per quarter of NdPr with full run-rate targeted by year-end; GM magnet deliveries targeted for end-2026 through PPAP; DoD is 100% offtaker of the 10X plant [3].

Workaround: Benchmark: light rare earths outside China remain oversupplied and ex-China PrNd fell more than 13% in August, while heavy rare earths are acutely short [2].

Why the indicator may be right

- Ex-China PrNd prices slipped below the $110/kg floor in MP's DoD agreement [2].
- PPA income ($17.6M) is more than half of Materials adjusted EBITDA ($32.5M); net loss $(20.3)M [1].
- Commercial magnet deliveries have not yet started [3].
- Jev value capture 0.28; supply lag 0.70 and workaround lag 0.68 also failed.

Evidence against the indicator

- Ex-China heavy rare earths are scarce (dysprosium CIF Europe ~16x China) [2], and MP expects Dy/Tb output by year-end for internal use [3].
- DoD offtake and a guaranteed minimum earnings level for 10X [3].
- Time gate 0.82 and entry barrier 0.76 passed.

Company value capture

Weak to Mixed. Economics lean on the DoD price floor and offtake; Magnetics adjusted EBITDA was $7.5M [1].

What would flip the indicator

Commercial magnet sales at market prices above the floor plus heavy rare earth sales at ex-China premiums would be needed. Removal of policy support would deepen the Temporary reading.

What to monitor

- GM magnet shipments in Q4 2026
- Ex-China PrNd price versus the $110/kg floor
- Start of Dy/Tb separation

Key risks (overall risk: Very High)

- Policy and appropriations dependence
- Execution on Independence and 10X
- Rare earth price volatility
- Heavy capex ($308M of PP&E additions in H1 2026) [1]

Jev second opinion

Model **jev-1.13.0** | durability (code): **Probably Temporary** | route: **pass** | bottleneckResearchScore: **60** | researchPriorityTier: **prioritize** (research-queue label only, not investment advice). Hard-to-Scale blocked by failed gate(s): supply lag, workaround lag, value capture.

Noul gate	P(true)	Result
1. Non-capital time gate	0.82	PASS
2. Qualified supply lag	0.70	FAIL
3. Workaround lag	0.68	FAIL
4. Observed entry barrier	0.76	PASS
5. Company value capture	0.28	FAIL

Score (0–4)	Value
evidence_strength	2.11
value_capture_strength	1.97
bottleneck_intensity	3.46
demand_durability	1.78
constraint_exclusivity	2.65
research_priority	2.35

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CCJ — Cameco Corporation

Theme: Western uranium mining and conversion supply under long-term contracts

Durability indicator: **Probably Temporary**

Confidence: Medium

Research horizon: 5+ years **Risk:** Medium-High

Thesis

Term uranium prices are at decade highs and primary supply is constrained, but uranium is a globally priced commodity where secondary supply and restarts can respond, so Jev failed supply lag, workaround and capture.

Three-clock assessment

Demand: UxC long-term contracting ~33 Mlb in H1 2026 versus ~27 Mlb a year earlier [2]; Cameco says utilities are still not contracting at replacement rate [3].

Qualified-supply: Kazatomprom is negotiating 2027 sulphuric acid supply under new Russian export approvals [5]; Jefferies notes financing, capex inflation and delays at development projects [4].

Workaround: Secondary inventories are a shrinking bridge per Jefferies [4]; restarts and ISR ramps respond to price (inference).

Why the indicator may be right

- Spot (~$89.50/lb) sits below term (~$96/lb) and 2026 contracting has lagged norms [4].
- Q2 uranium adjusted EBITDA fell to $252M from $352M on lower planned deliveries [1].
- Kazatomprom expects no material 2026 guidance impact from the acid measures [5].
- Jev failed supply lag (0.64), workaround lag (0.67) and value capture (0.44).

Evidence against the indicator

- Long-term price $95.50/lb at end-Q2, up $15.50 YoY [2].
- Market-related contracts now carry floors in the high $70s and ceilings around $160 [3].
- Time gate 0.81 and entry barrier 0.76 passed.

Company value capture

Mixed. Contracting discipline with floors and ceilings and H1 uranium adjusted EBITDA of $676M versus $641M [1][3], but no product differentiation in a commodity market.

What would flip the indicator

Replacement-rate contracting alongside failed project ramps (term price sustained above $100 with Kazakh constraints into 2027) could lift the supply-lag gate. A Kazakh or secondary-supply surplus would deepen the Temporary reading.

What to monitor

- UxC term volumes versus consumption
- Kazatomprom 2027 acid supply and production guidance
- Spot–term spread

Key risks (overall risk: Medium-High)

- Kazakhstan and Russia supply-chain geopolitics
- Commodity price cycle
- Reactor construction delays
- Mill and reagent disruptions

Jev second opinion

Model **jev-1.13.0** | durability (code): **Probably Temporary** | route: **pass** | bottleneckResearchScore: **60** | researchPriorityTier: **prioritize** (research-queue label only, not investment advice). Hard-to-Scale blocked by failed gate(s): supply lag, workaround lag, value capture.

Noul gate	P(true)	Result
1. Non-capital time gate	0.81	PASS
2. Qualified supply lag	0.64	FAIL
3. Workaround lag	0.67	FAIL
4. Observed entry barrier	0.76	PASS
5. Company value capture	0.44	FAIL

Score (0–4)	Value
evidence_strength	2.20
value_capture_strength	2.24
bottleneck_intensity	2.98
demand_durability	2.49
constraint_exclusivity	1.99
research_priority	2.49

Sources

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AVAV — AeroVironment, Inc.

Theme: Loitering munitions and tactical autonomous strike systems

Durability indicator: **Probably Temporary**

Confidence: Medium

Research horizon: 3–5 years **Risk:** High

Thesis

Army demand for loitering munitions is real (record $1.5B funded backlog), but DoD is deliberately buying cheap one-way attack drones from many vendors, so Jev failed all five gates and routed AVAV to watch.

Three-clock assessment

Demand: Funded backlog $1.5B (+37%), book-to-bill 1.4 [1]; Army plans ~$1.2B on LASSO over FY26–FY31 [3].

Qualified-supply: AV is expanding capacity with FY2027 capex at 12–14% of revenue [4].

Workaround: Drone Dominance aims for more than 200,000 UAS by 2027; Gauntlet 2 tested 23 platforms from 19 companies [2].

Why the indicator may be right

- Many vendors are clearing DoD evaluations for low-cost attack drones [2].
- The Army is looking to add more platforms to LASSO [3].
- GAAP net loss $(5.1)M and FY2027 net income guidance of only $10–27M [1].
- Jev failed all five gates; re-run with added transcript evidence did not change the route (watch).

Evidence against the indicator

- Switchblade 400 selected for LASSO and a $51M Switchblade 600 order in the quarter [3][4].
- Munition-class systems need DoD qualification and ITAR handling (inference from program structure).
- Management reports rising international loitering-munition demand [4] (management claim).

Company value capture

Mixed. Gross margin 26% (21% a year earlier) and adjusted EBITDA $53.4M [1], but thin GAAP profitability and competitive procurement.

What would flip the indicator

Sole-source, multi-year production awards for LASSO or next-generation loitering munitions that low-cost drones cannot meet would be needed. Share loss to Gauntlet winners would deepen the Temporary reading.

What to monitor

- LASSO production decisions
- Drone Dominance phase awards and unit prices
- AV gross margin and capacity ramp

Key risks (overall risk: High)

- Budget and continuing-resolution risk
- Disruption by low-cost drones
- Capacity execution
- Acquisition integration (BlueHalo)

Jev second opinion

Model **jev-1.13.0** | durability (code): **Probably Temporary** | route: **watch** | bottleneckResearchScore: **56** | researchPriorityTier: **prioritize** (research-queue label only, not investment advice). Hard-to-Scale blocked by failed gate(s): time gate, supply lag, workaround lag, entry barrier, value capture. Re-run once with added evidence (watch route); second-run values shown.

Noul gate	P(true)	Result
1. Non-capital time gate	0.48	FAIL
2. Qualified supply lag	0.64	FAIL
3. Workaround lag	0.44	FAIL
4. Observed entry barrier	0.32	FAIL
5. Company value capture	0.39	FAIL

Score (0–4)	Value
evidence_strength	1.97
value_capture_strength	2.21
bottleneck_intensity	2.41
demand_durability	2.61
constraint_exclusivity	2.11
research_priority	2.14

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VRT — Vertiv Holdings Co

Theme: AI data-center power and liquid-cooling infrastructure

Durability indicator: **Probably Temporary**

Confidence: Medium

Research horizon: 2–3 years **Risk:** Medium-High

Thesis

AI rack densification drives Vertiv's power and liquid-cooling growth with expanding margins, but around 40 CDU vendors, active M&A and largely standard manufacturing let supply respond quickly, so Jev routed VRT to watch.

Three-clock assessment

Demand: Dell'Oro: data center physical infrastructure +28% YoY in 1Q 2026 with thermal management up nearly 50% [2]; Vertiv Q2 sales +24% [1].

Qualified-supply: Vertiv is expanding in Johor, Americas plants and EMEA chillers; Q2 congestion described as temporary [1][4].

Workaround: ~40 CDU vendors (Sept 2025) [3]; Ecolab–CoolIT and Legrand deals add capacity [2].

Why the indicator may be right

- Observed entry and M&A are heavy in CDUs and liquid cooling [2][3].
- Management calls supply-chain congestion temporary and expects it to resolve in 2H 2026 [4].
- Dell'Oro flags U.S. permitting delays and slipping giga-scale projects [2].
- Jev failed all five gates (value capture 0.66 was the highest).

Evidence against the indicator

- Adjusted operating margin +410 bp on favorable price-cost [1].
- Deferred revenue doubled to $3.63B since December on customer down payments [1].
- Dell'Oro expects consolidation to fewer than 10 dominant CDU vendors by decade end [3].

Company value capture

Mixed. Margin expansion, $1.1B Q2 operating cash flow and a net cash position [1], against hyperscaler bargaining power and many competitors.

What would flip the indicator

Lengthening lead times and share gains while consolidation removes entrants would be needed. Pricing erosion or order slowdowns would deepen the Temporary reading.

What to monitor

- Q3 2026 orders and backlog disclosures
- Adjusted operating margin versus tariffs
- Competitor capacity and M&A

Key risks (overall risk: Medium-High)

- AI capex cyclicality
- Hyperscaler concentration
- Competition from Schneider, Eaton and specialists
- Tariffs and supply chain

Jev second opinion

Model **jev-1.13.0** | durability (code): **Probably Temporary** | route: **watch** | bottleneckResearchScore: **53** | researchPriorityTier: **prioritize** (research-queue label only, not investment advice). Hard-to-Scale blocked by failed gate(s): time gate, supply lag, workaround lag, entry barrier, value capture. Re-run once with added evidence (watch route); second-run values shown.

Noul gate	P(true)	Result
1. Non-capital time gate	0.69	FAIL
2. Qualified supply lag	0.54	FAIL
3. Workaround lag	0.46	FAIL
4. Observed entry barrier	0.41	FAIL
5. Company value capture	0.66	FAIL

Score (0–4)	Value
evidence_strength	1.69
value_capture_strength	2.99
bottleneck_intensity	1.83
demand_durability	2.36
constraint_exclusivity	1.78
research_priority	1.90

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FCX — Freeport-McMoRan Inc.

Theme: Copper mine supply for electrification

Durability indicator: **Probably Temporary**

Confidence: High

Research horizon: 3–5 years **Risk:** High

Thesis

Copper mine supply is structurally slow and concentrate is scarce, but Freeport is a price-taking producer and ICSG forecasts refined surpluses for 2026–27, so Jev failed four gates including value capture.

Three-clock assessment

Demand: ICSG cut 2026 demand growth to 1.6% and forecasts a 96kt refined surplus in 2026 and 377kt in 2027 [4].

Qualified-supply: Grasberg district at ~65% of capacity in 2H 2026, 80% by mid-2027, near full by end-2027 [2]; ore grades down 40% since 1991 [5].

Workaround: Secondary (scrap) output is rising [4]; the TC/RC benchmark settled at $0/t in 2026 [5].

Why the indicator may be right

- ICSG flipped from a 150kt deficit forecast to surpluses [4].
- Freeport earns through price, not control of a chokepoint; Q2 profit beat came from higher prices despite 18.2% lower output [3].
- Grasberg's recovery adds supply through 2027 [2].
- Jev failed supply lag, workaround lag, entry barrier and value capture (0.16).

Evidence against the indicator

- A $0 TC/RC benchmark shows concentrate scarcity and miner leverage over smelters [5].
- Brownfield capital intensity is up 65% since 2020 and discoveries are falling [5].
- Refined output is forecast to grow only 0.4% in 2026 [4]; time gate 0.88 passed.

Company value capture

Weak. Q2 net income of $984M was driven by copper and gold prices [1][3]; there is no contractual pricing power over the constraint.

What would flip the indicator

Persistent refined deficits despite Grasberg's recovery and rising scrap, with returns holding through mid-cycle prices; still unlikely to clear the capture gate without contractual pricing power.

What to monitor

- Grasberg ramp versus plan
- ICSG's next forecast update
- TC/RCs and U.S. copper tariff decisions

Key risks (overall risk: High)

- Indonesia operations and geopolitics
- Commodity price cycle
- Tariff policy
- Cost inflation (Grasberg repair costs ~$363M in Q2) [3]

Jev second opinion

Model **jev-1.13.0** | durability (code): **Probably Temporary** | route: **watch** | bottleneckResearchScore: **44** | researchPriorityTier: **watch** (research-queue label only, not investment advice). Hard-to-Scale blocked by failed gate(s): supply lag, workaround lag, entry barrier, value capture. Re-run once with added evidence (watch route); second-run values shown.

Noul gate	P(true)	Result
1. Non-capital time gate	0.88	PASS
2. Qualified supply lag	0.37	FAIL
3. Workaround lag	0.28	FAIL
4. Observed entry barrier	0.31	FAIL
5. Company value capture	0.16	FAIL

Score (0–4)	Value
evidence_strength	1.85
value_capture_strength	1.65
bottleneck_intensity	2.12
demand_durability	1.71
constraint_exclusivity	1.70
research_priority	1.32

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How to use the watchlist

This is a research funnel, not a recommendation list. A Probably Temporary bottleneck can still produce a short windfall for the company that holds it, and a Potentially Hard to Scale bottleneck can still be a poor investment if valuation, balance sheet or governance fail. Suggested sequence: (1) read the primary filings and releases cited in each deep dive; (2) check competitors, customers and regulators for capacity additions, redesigns or second sourcing that would disconfirm the thesis; (3) form an independent valuation view, which this report does not provide; (4) write down invalidation conditions in advance, using the flip conditions above. bottleneckResearchScore, researchPriorityTier and the Jev route order research attention only and must never be used as position-size or timing signals. Watch-routed names (AVAV, VRT, FCX) need better evidence before deeper work.

Changes versus the 21 Sep 2026 list

Kept: AVAV, BWXT, CCJ, FCX, GEV, MP, VRT (re-researched from new sources). Removed: AMKR and COHR (same AI data-center/accelerator spending pool as VRT; both were Jev watch on 21 Sep) and BE (onsite power for data centers, same pool; it had already been replaced in the 21 Sep run artifacts). Added: ASML (EUV lithography; listed in the 21 Sep run artifacts in place of BE), HWM (jet-engine airfoil castings) and SHC (Cobalt-60 and sterilization, covering the healthcare-infrastructure/nuclear-medicine theme after BWXT announced the sale of its medical isotope business).

Selected sources

Every URL cited in the body, and no others. Grouped by stock in report order, then framework references cited in the methodology. Freshness: all current-condition claims rely on sources dated 4 Apr 2026 or later. Five stock sources are older than ~6 months and are used only for structural or regulatory context, each paired with a newer source: Dell'Oro CDU vendor count (2025-09-30; VRT), Manufacturing Dive (2026-02-24; GEV), IEA copper (2026-03-02; FCX), NextBeam Co-60 outlook (2026-03-13; SHC) and the Federal Register EtO proposal (2026-03-17; SHC).

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End of report. Classification mix: 0 Potentially Hard to Scale / 10 Probably Temporary. Artifacts: output/2026-10-04/ (packets, jev_results, final_watchlist_summary.json, generator).